Before using a washing machine it is important to study the maker's instructions.

A typical household machine takes a load of 6 to 7 lb. The machine should never be over loaded.

- When washing a load of mixed fabrics wash according to type of fabric.
- Collars and cuffs may need a gentle rub by hand to remove completely the already loosened dirt.
- Give time according to the articles being washed.
- Rinse thoroughly.



Figure 5.15 Washing Machine

Types of Washing Machine

Although most washing machines have same basic functions each machine may be slightly different so it's very important to read instructions. Washing machines are either front loading or top loading machines. For front loading washers, the door is located on the side in front while top loading machines have the lid on the very top of the washer. Most washing machines have several settings that will determine the correct temperature of the water and the length of each spin cycle.



Front Loading Top Loading

Figure 5.16 Types of Washing Machine

5.3.2 Fabric Softeners

Fabric softener (called fabric conditioner) is used to prevent static cling and make fabric softer. Some brands of washing powder have fabric conditioning built-in which is claimed to save money when compared to buying ordinary washing powder and fabric softener separately.

Fabric softeners work by coating the surface of the cloth fibres with a thin layer of chemicals. These chemicals have lubricant properties and are electrically conductive, thus making the fibres feel smoother and preventing build up of static electricity. The other functions are increased resistance to stains and reduction of wrinkling.

5.3.2.1 Types

Fabric softener are classified into two types

- Cationic Fabric Softeners
- Anionic Fabric Softeners

- **Cationic Fabric Softeners**

Cationic fabric softeners usually contain cationic surfactants of the quaternary ammonium type as the main active ingredient. Cationic surfactants adhere well to natural fibres but less to synthetic

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